

The Ultimate Web Development Handbook



Formatting Text in HTML

HTML allows you to format your text using different tags. These tags help make your content easier to read and visually appealing.

Bold Text

Use the `<b>` or `<strong>` tag to make text bold.

```
<p>This is <b>bold</b> text.</p>  
<p>This is <strong>important</strong> text.</p>
```

- `<strong>` also means the text is important (for screen readers and SEO).
-

Italic Text

Use the `<i>` or `<em>` tag to italicize text.

```
<p>This is <i>italic</i> text.</p>  
<p>This is <em>emphasized</em> text.</p>
```

- `<em>` gives extra emphasis and has meaning, especially for accessibility.
-

Underlined Text

Use the `<u>` tag to underline text.

```
<p>This is <u>underlined</u> text.</p>
```

Strikethrough Text

Use the `<s>` or `<del>` tag to show deleted or crossed-out text.

```
<p>This is <s>wrong</s> text.</p>  
<p>Old price: <del>$100</del> New price: $80</p>
```

Superscript and Subscript

Use `<sup>` for superscript (above line), `<sub>` for subscript (below line).

```
<p>Water is H<sub>2</sub>O.</p>  
<p>E = mc<sup>2</sup></p>
```

Combining Formats

You can combine formatting tags.

```
<p>This is <b><i>bold and italic</i></b> text.</p>
```

Summary of Formatting Tags

Tag	Purpose
<code></code>	Bold (no meaning)
<code></code>	Bold (important)
<code><i></code>	Italic (no meaning)
<code></code>	Italic (emphasis)
<code><u></code>	Underline
<code><s></code>	Strikethrough
<code></code>	Deleted text
<code><sub></code>	Subscript
<code><sup></code>	Superscript

Comments and Whitespace in HTML

HTML Comments

Comments are notes in your HTML code that are ignored by the browser. They are useful for explaining code or leaving reminders.

Syntax:

```
<!-- This is a comment -->  
<p>This is visible content.</p>  
<!-- <p>This line will not show on the webpage.</p> -->
```

Comments do not appear on the webpage. They're only visible in the source code.

Whitespace in HTML

Whitespace includes spaces, tabs, and newlines (Enter key). HTML treats multiple spaces as a **single space**.

Example:

```
<p>This is spaced.</p>
```

This will be displayed as:

This is spaced.

If you want to preserve spaces and line breaks, use the `<pre>` tag.

Example:

```
<pre>
This   is   preformatted
      text.
</pre>
```

Tip

- Use comments to explain your HTML when needed.
- Use proper indentation (whitespace) to make your code readable, even though HTML doesn't require it.

Links and Anchor Tags

Creating Links in HTML

HTML uses the `<a>` tag to create links.

The `href` attribute tells the browser **where** the link should go.

Basic Syntax:

```
<a href="https://www.example.com">Visit Example</a>
```

This creates a clickable link that takes you to the specified URL.

Opening Links in a New Tab

Use the `target="_blank"` attribute to open the link in a new tab.

```
<a href="https://www.google.com" target="_blank">Open Google</a>
```

Linking to Other Pages (Internal Links)

You can also link to other pages of your own website.

```
<a href="about.html">About Us</a>
```

Link to a Section on the Same Page

Use the `id` attribute and a hash (`#`) to jump to a section.

```
<a href="#contact">Go to Contact</a>

...

<h2 id="contact">Contact Section</h2>
```

Email and Phone Links

- Email Link:

```
<a href="mailto:hello@example.com">Send Email</a>
```

- Phone Link:

```
<a href="tel:+1234567890">Call Us</a>
```

Styling Links (Default Behavior)

- **Normal:** Blue and underlined
- **Visited:** Purple
- **Hover:** Changes color when mouse is over it
- **Active:** Red while clicking

These styles can be changed with CSS later.